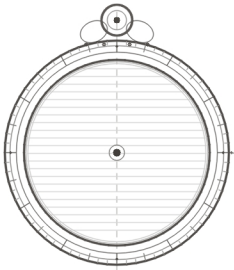
Anatomy of the Artifact

I. The Mater (The Mother)

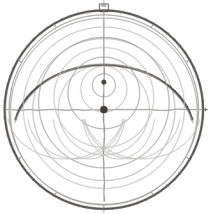
Heavy outer bronze casing
holding internal plates.
Limbus divided into 24 hours
and 360 angular degrees.
Recessed bed prevents warping.



The Mater: 360° limbus & base frame

II. The Tympan (Horizon Plate)

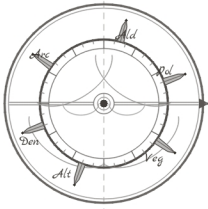
Exchangeable disc engraved for
Latitude 38° 12 (Sanctuary Datum).
Stereographic curves show altitude
circles converging at the zenith.



The Tympan: Almucantars for Lat. 38° 12

III. The Rete (The Star Web)

Openwork bronze skeleton of sky.
Concentric ring traces the zodiac.
Flame pointers mark guide stars.



The Rete: Ecliptic band & 6 star pointers

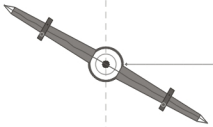
The 6 Star Pointers (Mucrones)

1. Ald – Aldebaran (Taurus)
2. Pol – Polaris (Ursa Minor)
3. Veg – Vega (Lyra)
4. Alt – Altair (Aquila)
5. Den – Deneb (Cygnus)
6. Arc – Arcturus (Bootes)

Flame tips indicate sidereal hours on limbus

IV. The Alidade (Sight Rule)

Revolving sighting ruler on back.
Dual pinholes measure star altitude.



The Alidade: Elevation sighting ruler

V. The Horse Wedge (Equus)

Traditional locking wedge holding plates.
Slips out instantly to swap horizons.



The Horse Wedge: Locks central axis pin

